

JETRO Business Brief 2026/08/17

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【ASIA-OCEANIA】

The Chinese Cross-Border Interbank Payment System (CIPS) service has launched in Namibia, with China strengthening cooperation with Namibia and South Africa in critical minerals and other sectors (China, Namibia, South Africa, Africa).

Chinese mainland companies' Hong Kong listings have exceeded 2025's full-year IPO fundraising in January-July 2026 (China, Hong Kong).

Shenzhen signed a strategic cooperation framework agreement with Walmart China (China, US).

July's Chinese automobile sales saw NEVs exceed 60% of the mix, with exports surpassing 1 million units for the second consecutive month (China).

Shanghai announced an action plan targeting economic effects of over 100 billion yuan from sporting events by 2028 (China).

China has published mandatory national standards for safety requirements for autonomous driving levels 3 and 4 (China).

First-half automobile production declined 1.0% year-on-year (Thailand).

Vietnam's e-commerce market first-half sales grew 44.1%, with expanded sales of premium-priced products (Vietnam).

India's July inflation rate of 4.45% year-on-year exceeded the RBI's mid-term target for the second consecutive month (India).

Yamaha Motor's import agent AMW renovated its Yamaha store in Colombo Borella (Sri Lanka, Japan).

June's trade balance shifted to a surplus of A\$1.928 billion (Australia).

【NORTH AMERICA, CENTRAL AND SOUTH AMERICA】

The US USTR announced resolution of labor issues at Yazaki Group's Mexico factory, resuming tariff clearance (US, Mexico).

Japanese seasonings were introduced in Texas, promoting umami from store demonstrations to everyday American consumption (US, Japan).

July's US consumer price index showed slowdown for the second consecutive month, with declines in gasoline prices (US).

President Trump decided to apply Section 232 tariffs to drone and drone component imports, to take effect in September (US).

July's US retail sales declined 0.6% month-on-month, marking the first decline in 9 months contrary to expectations (US).

【EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA, AND CAUCASUS】

A heat alert was issued in the UK for the fifth heatwave of 2026, with drought occurring in 70% of England (UK).

A meeting was held regarding river water level decline, restricting inland waterway transport and affecting logistics networks and production (Germany).

BMW commenced pilot operation of a process water treatment facility (Germany).

【MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA】

Canadevienne concluded a contract for Morocco's first integrated waste power generation project (Morocco, Switzerland, Japan).